

Advanced English Vocabulary

1. Obdurate (*adj.*)

Meaning: Stubbornly refusing to change one's opinion or course of action.

Example:

Despite overwhelming evidence, he remained **obdurate** in his beliefs.

2. Intransigent (*adj.*)

Meaning: Unwilling to compromise or change views.

Example:

The negotiations failed due to the committee's **intransigent** attitude.

3. Recondite (*adj.*)

Meaning: Little known; difficult to understand; obscure.

Example:

The professor's lecture was filled with **recondite** theories.

4. Lugubrious (*adj.*)

Meaning: Looking or sounding sad and gloomy.

Example:

He spoke in a **lugubrious** tone about the state of the economy.

5. Vicissitude (*noun*)

Meaning: A change of circumstances, often unpleasant.

Example:

She faced many **vicissitudes** before achieving success.

6. Equivocate (*verb*)

Meaning: To speak ambiguously to avoid telling the truth.

Example:

When questioned directly, the politician began to **equivocate**.

7. Obfuscate (*verb*)

Meaning: To deliberately make something unclear or confusing.

Example:

The report was written to **obfuscate** the real issue.

8. Sycophantic (*adj.*)

Meaning: Excessively flattering for personal gain.

Example:

His **sycophantic** praise annoyed the senior management.

9. Pulchritude (*noun*)

Meaning: Physical beauty (formal, rare).

Example:

The painting captured the timeless **pulchritude** of nature.

10. Excoriate (*verb*)

Meaning: To criticize severely.

Example:

The media **excoriated** the company for unethical practices.

11. Contumacious (*adj.*)

Meaning: Stubbornly disobedient to authority.

Example:

His **contumacious** behavior led to disciplinary action.

12. Perspicacious (*adj.*)

Meaning: Having a keen understanding and insight.

Example:

She made a **perspicacious** observation that changed the strategy.

13. Insouciant (*adj.*)

Meaning: Showing a casual lack of concern; indifferent.

Example:

He appeared **insouciant** despite the seriousness of the situation.

14. Trenchant (*adj.*)

Meaning: Sharp, incisive, and forceful (speech or writing).

Example:

Her **trenchant** critique exposed major flaws in the proposal.

15. Propitious (*adj.*)

Meaning: Favorable; likely to lead to success.

Example:

The economic climate was **propitious** for new investments.
